

Data quality report: SBA 7(a) loan-level FOIA data

Snapshot as of 2026-06-30, compared with 2026-03-31. Generated by the pipeline in [loan-data-quality-pipeline](#). Borrower names and street addresses are dropped on read and appear nowhere in the outputs.

1,624,422

Rows checked

1,624,400

In clean table (no errors)

22

Quarantined (errors)

44,497

Flagged (warnings)

26

Rules

1. Schema and format drift between snapshots

The publisher changed the file format between quarters. The contract maps both formats to one schema; each fix applied is counted.

Item	2026-03-31	2026-06-30
Header style	unquoted, lowercase (3 files)	quoted, CamelCase (3 files)
Columns not in the contract	subprogram	none
Contract columns missing	none	none
approval date: US date format	1,610,065	0
as of date: US date format	1,610,065	0
bank zip: lost leading zero	130,997	0
borrower zip: lost leading zero	124,041	0
charge off date: US date format	183,834	0
collateral: TRUE/FALSE coding	1,610,065	0
first disbursement date: US date format	1,390,061	0
loan status: respelled	0	923,144
paid in full date: US date format	913,571	0
revolver: TRUE/FALSE coding	1,610,065	0

Columns whose share of missing values changed by more than 1 point: none.

2. Validation rules on the 2026-06-30 snapshot

Errors keep a row out of the clean table (it goes to quarantine with the rule ids); warnings keep the row and flag it; info rules count known features of the source.

Rule	Severity	Check	Description	Rows failing	Rate	Example (non-personal fields)
C1	error	completeness	Approval date is missing or unparseable	0	0.000%	
C2	error	completeness	Loan or guarantee amount is missing or not a number	0	0.000%	

C3	error	completeness	Loan status is missing	0	0.000%	
C4	info	completeness	Interest rate is missing (expected for loans approved through FY2009)	653,708	40.242%	interest_rate=missing; approval_fy=2000
C5	warning	completeness	Business type is missing	584	0.036%	business_type=missing
C6	warning	completeness	Interest rate is missing for a loan approved in FY2010 or later	8	<0.001%	interest_rate=missing; approval_fy=2024
V1	error	validity	Loan status is not one of the documented codes	0	0.000%	
V2	error	validity	Project state is not a valid U.S. state or territory code	0	0.000%	
V3	warning	validity	Borrower ZIP is not five digits after normalization	0	0.000%	
V4	error	validity	Loan amount is zero or negative	0	0.000%	
V5	error	validity	Interest rate is outside 0-25%	2	<0.001%	interest_rate=56.0
V6	warning	validity	Interest rate is below 2% (likely an entry error)	1,121	0.069%	interest_rate=1.75
V7	warning	validity	Term is missing, under 1 month or over 40 years	1,156	0.071%	term_months=0.0
V8	error	validity	Jobs supported is negative	0	0.000%	
V9	warning	validity	NAICS code is missing or not six digits	19,779	1.218%	naics_code=missing
V10	warning	validity	Business type is not one of the documented values	0	0.000%	
X1	error	consistency	SBA guarantee exceeds the loan amount	0	0.000%	
X2	error	consistency	Approval fiscal year does not match the approval date (federal FY starts October 1)	0	0.000%	
X3	error	consistency	Charged-off loan has no charge-off date, or a charge-off date without charged-off status	20	0.001%	loan_status=CHGOFF; charge_off_date=missing
X4	warning	consistency	Paid-in-full loan has no paid-in-full date	0	0.000%	
X5	error	consistency	Charge-off date is before the approval date	0	0.000%	
X6	warning	consistency	Charge-off amount exceeds the loan amount	5,267	0.324%	charge_off_amount=72245.5; gross_approval=50000.0
X7	error	consistency	Approval date is after the snapshot date	0	0.000%	
X8	warning	consistency	First disbursement is before approval	434	0.027%	first_disbursement_date=1999-10-31; approval_date=1999-12-23
K1	info	known issue	Term is not a standard contractual length (SBA rewrites the term of some loans after approval)	403,496	24.839%	term_months=306.0; loan_status=PIF
U1	warning	uniqueness	Snapshot key is shared with another loan (cannot be tracked across snapshots)	16,509	1.016%	

3. What changed between snapshots

Loans are matched on fields fixed at approval (date, amounts, ZIP, state, jobs, rate). No names or addresses are used.

Rows	1,610,065	1,624,422
Matched to the same loan in both	1,592,944	
Only in the earlier snapshot	662	
Only in the later snapshot (new loans)		14,969
Key shared by several loans (not trackable)	16,459	16,509

Matched loans whose field changed between the two snapshots. Status and dates are expected to change; the others were fixed at approval. (Key fields cannot appear here: a loan whose key field changed fails to match and is counted in the rows above.)

Field	Loans changed
NAICS code	83
county	24
business type	154
term (months)	1,287
loan status	22,973
charge-off date	2,069
paid-in-full date	9,648

73 loans that were resolved in the earlier snapshot (paid in full or charged off) are active or undisbursed again in the later one. A resolved loan should not reopen, so these are worth raising with the publisher.

200 of the new loans match a removed loan on approval date, loan amount, borrower ZIP, project state: probably the same loan with a revised key field (SBA guarantee: 120, jobs supported: 81). They are counted, not merged.

Most common status changes:

From	To	Loans
EXEMPT	PIF	9,277
COMMIT	EXEMPT	8,159
COMMIT	CANCLD	3,355
EXEMPT	CHGOFF	1,790
CHGOFF	PIF	253
PIF	EXEMPT	59
COMMIT	PIF	48
CHGOFF	EXEMPT	14

Notes

Term (months) is not a reliable approval-time field: SBA rewrites it for some loans after approval. Rule K1 counts non-standard terms, and section 3 shows terms changing between quarters.

Interest rates are missing for most loans approved through FY2009 (rule C4). That is a property of the source, so it is counted as info; a missing rate on a later loan is a warning (rule C6).

Active loans have status EXEMPT because SBA withholds their status under FOIA exemption 4.